OLD-FASHIONED BUTTER COOKIES

YIELD	REST	OVEN	ENERGY COST
50 cookies	**1 h chill after pressing**	**350F, 13-16 min**	**$1.58 (16 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

113 g	Unsalted butter, softened
113 g	Butter-flavored shortening
150 g	Granulated sugar
2 g	Sea salt
2	Egg yolks
7.5 ml	Vanilla extract
2.5 ml	Butter emulsion, optional
250 g	All-purpose flour

METHOD

1. Cream the butter and shortening smooth.
2. Add sugar and salt, beat about 2 minutes until fluffy and uniform.
3. Mix in the yolks, the vanilla and the butter emulsion if using, scraping down.
4. Stir in the flour a little at a time with a spatula to a soft uniform dough.
5. Knead lightly by hand to pick up the last of the flour.
6. Press through a cookie press, or pipe with an open star tip, packed close since the tray is going in the fridge.
7. Chill 1 hour, then space them 1 to 2 inches apart on a fresh lined sheet.
8. Bake at 350F for 13 to 16 minutes until the edges are golden. Watch them from 13.
9. Leave on the pan until cool. They are fragile warm and crisp up as they cool.

NOTES

Half the fat is shortening, which is what holds the pressed shape.
Highest yield of the butter cookies at 50, so it is the one for volume.
Overbaking dries them out. Golden edges means stop.
Keeps for weeks airtight.

LEARNINGS

- 4 overall. Appearance and flavor both 4 but texture only 3.5, the weakest texture of the five made, which is the shortening trade-off for holding shape. Easy, and the 50-cookie yield is the real argument for it.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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